



◀ **BOSE SOUNDLINK
SPEAKER III**

Price: ₹22,388



Bluetooth Speakers

Our bluetooth speaker comparison test this year was quite an eye opening experience. One insight was that bluetooth speakers are not a gimmick – they're a category that's here to stay. We did see a multitude of speakers in all shapes and sizes offering a whole lot of unique features this year. Some could be daisy chained wirelessly to other speakers, some were rugged enough to be thrown around, some even resistant to water splashes, and then there were a few that did come close to the audio quality and power that you expect from wired speakers and in a few rare cases exceeded those expectations. Those are speakers we'll be talking about in our Zero1 awards writeup this time around.

Zero1 Winner

Bose SoundLink Speaker III

The predecessor to this superlative speaker – the SoundLink Speaker II – was our winner in the bluetooth comparison test we did early this year in February. Naturally our expectations from its next iteration – the SoundLink Speaker III – were high. And it does not disappoint. The Bose SoundLink Speaker III takes off beautifully from where the SoundLink II left off. It's about the same size but significantly improves bass performance and extreme highs. Now every high cymbal comes soaring above everything else and the lows are deeper than anything we've heard in the portable space. It's louder this time around, too. All in all at ₹22,388 it's the best portable speaker money can buy, and yes it's a significant cache of moolah. Money well spent, though.



**Get Together by
House of Marley**

Price: ₹19,990



JBL Charge

Price: ₹6,000



**Bose SoundLink
Mini**

Price: ₹16,875



JBL Pulse

Price: ₹9,000

Worthy Mentions

Get Together by House of Marley

Made out of natural bamboo and fabric, this monstrosity although humongous, is certainly nice to look at. Not very big on clarity or precision, it's big on decibel levels. It is the loudest portable speaker we've had, nudging out the previous title holder – the Logitech UE Boombox. The Get Together's dual 3.5 inch drivers and 1-inch dome tweeters belt out a collective 20W RMS which is enough to get your outdoor party grooving. Be warned it's heavy and bulky but if volume is what you are looking for it might suit your needs. At ₹19,990 it's not exactly cheap and you might want to also consider our Zero1 winner which is only a shade less loud but leaps ahead w.r.t. audio quality.

JBL Charge

The Charge has been a long favourite here at the Digit Test labs for two reasons: one, it manages to combine two different product categories – a power bank and portable speakers, and two it doesn't compromise on audio quality. The powerful 6000 mAh battery makes for a much stronger use case for carrying around another device in your bag. If you're in the mood for some tunes, it's a rich and powerful speaker. For times when you're running out of juice on your phone, it's a life saving breath of power. At a market price of about ₹6,000 it's a value for money for purchase.

Bose SoundLink Mini

The SoundLink is an impressive piece of engineering wizardry to begin with. Its passive radiators are supposed to face opposite directions reducing vibrations. And guess what, it works! The ability of this little thing to churn out radiating, room-filling lows was impressive. It's deceptively loud and impressively accurate. Its small but heavy so not exactly ultra portable. At a price of ₹16,875 it provides a great price option between the mid range JBLs and the ultra-high end SoundLink III.

JBL Pulse

The JBL Pulse is a funky little novelty number that doesn't sound bad at all. With the integrated array of LEDs on its grille, it's like a modern day rendition of a lava lamp. These lights "pulse" to the music that you're playing in five pre-programmed patterns (with additional patterns available for download via an app). The colours and the patterns look quite trippy and the speaker is quite the conversation starter. At its street price of about ₹9,000 it's a must buy if you want something different from your portable audio. 